

Chapter 3: Quantization of Bosonic Strings

1. For simplicity we will ignore the μ index in our calculation first.

First consider $[L_m, L_n]$ with $m + n \neq 0$. Then expanding in terms of commutators: This is the same as before, but now we must be careful about commutation:

$$[L_m, L_n] = \frac{1}{4} \sum_{k,l} [:\alpha_{m-k}\alpha_k: , : \alpha_{n-l}\alpha_l:]$$

Note that the indices $m-k, k, n-l, l$ sum to $n+m$, if any pairwise sum of them is equal to zero (necessary for a nonvanishing commutator), then the other two will have sum equal to $n+m$. Then as long as $m+n \neq 0$, there will be no normal-ordering ambiguity and we will recover the standard commutation relations as before.

So the remaining case to consider is $n = -m$. Take m positive WLOG. The logic of the question from last chapter applies, but now we must be careful about the ordering of the α_i outside of the commutator.

$$\begin{aligned} [L_m, L_{-m}] &= \frac{1}{4} \sum_{k,l} [\alpha_{m-k}\alpha_k, \alpha_{-m-l}\alpha_l] \\ &= \frac{1}{4} \sum_{k,l} \alpha_{m-k}\alpha_l k \delta_{k-m-l} + \alpha_{-m-l}\alpha_k (m-k) \delta_{m-k+l} + \alpha_{-m-l}\alpha_{m-k} k \delta_{k+l} + \alpha_k \alpha_l (m-k) \delta_{k+l} \quad (1) \\ &= \frac{1}{4} \sum_k \alpha_{m-k}\alpha_{k-m} k + \alpha_{-k}\alpha_k (m-k) + \alpha_{-m+k}\alpha_{m-k} k + \alpha_k \alpha_{-k} (m-k) \end{aligned}$$

We can split this into $k \geq 1$ and $k \leq -1$. The $k = 0$ term is already in normal order. When $k \geq 1$, the first, third, and fourth terms of the sum are out of normal order. The first term has only m terms out of normal order. Rearranging these gives the constant:

$$\frac{1}{4} \sum_{k=1}^m k(m-k) = \frac{1}{4} \frac{m(m^2-1)}{6}$$

The fourth term has all terms out of normal order and gives the formally infinite sum

$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} k(m-k)$$

The last term has all but the first m terms out of normal order, and so contributes the sum

$$\sum_{k=m+1}^{\infty} (-m+k)k = - \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} (m-k)k + \sum_{k=1}^m (m-k)k$$

The first part of this exactly cancels with the third term's infinite contribution. The last part of this gives exactly the same contribution as the first term.

Now, for $k \leq -1$ only the first two terms contribute. The first term contributes $\sum_k (m-k)k$ while the second term contributes $\sum_k (-k)(m-k)$ which cancel. Thus the term left behind is exactly:

$$2 \times \frac{1}{4} \frac{m(m^2-1)}{6} = \frac{m(m^2-1)}{12} \quad (2)$$

Note however that in fact our oscillators carry with them a μ index which we have ignored. If we incorporate it, then each normal ordering of $\alpha_i^\mu \alpha_\nu^j$ will include a factor of $\eta^{\mu\nu}$ which would have to be summed over. This will add in a copy of D to our final result for the normal ordering term.

Finally, we see that the normal ordering constant a must be equal to:

$$\frac{1}{2} \sum_k \alpha_{-k}^i \alpha_k^i \rightarrow \sum_{k=0} \alpha_{-k}^i \alpha_k^i + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{k>0} [\alpha_k^i, \alpha_{-k}^i] =: L_0 : + \underbrace{\frac{D-2}{2} \sum_k k}_{\zeta(-1)} =: L_0 : - \frac{D-2}{24} \quad (3)$$

2. I believe that the treatment of the prior derivation of the central term was sufficiently careful, as I did not need to use any zeta regularization to compute an infinite sum. I only used zeta regularization in calculating the normal-ordering constant
3. Given that the Witt algebra is already given as an associative algebra, the commutator directly satisfies the Jacobi identity, since $(a - (b - c)) + (b - (c - a)) + (c - (a - b)) = a + b + c = 0$. Adding a central term gives

$$[L_a, [L_b, L_c]] + [L_b, [L_c, L_a]] + [L_c, [L_a, L_b]] = \frac{1}{12} \delta_{a+b+c} (a(a^2-1)(b-c) + b(b^2-1)(c-a) + c(c^2-1)(a-b)) \quad (4)$$

This is zero by algebra.

4. For the closed string, we have:

$$\begin{aligned} \dot{X}^\mu(\tau, \sigma) &= \ell_s^2 p^\mu + \frac{\ell_s}{\sqrt{2}} \sum_{n \neq 0} (\alpha_n^\mu e^{-in\sigma} + \bar{\alpha}_n^\mu e^{in\sigma}) e^{-in\tau} \\ X'^\mu(\tau, \sigma) &= \frac{\ell_s}{\sqrt{2}} \sum_{n \neq 0} (\alpha_n^\mu e^{-in\sigma} - \bar{\alpha}_n^\mu e^{in\sigma}) e^{-in\tau} \end{aligned}$$

Taking $X^+ = x^+ + \ell_s^2 p^+ \tau$ sets $\alpha_n^+, \bar{\alpha}_n^+ = 0$ for all $n \neq 0$.

$$\begin{aligned} \dot{X}^\mu + X'^\mu &= \ell_s^2 p^\mu + \sqrt{2} \ell_s \sum_{n \neq 0} \alpha_n^\mu e^{-in\sigma} e^{-in\tau} \\ \dot{X}^\mu - X'^\mu &= \ell_s^2 p^\mu + \sqrt{2} \ell_s \sum_{n \neq 0} \bar{\alpha}_n^\mu e^{in\sigma} e^{-in\tau} \end{aligned}$$

Let's just look at the constraint $(\dot{X} + X')^2 = 0$ and then the other constraint will give the same result for the right-movers.

$$0 = \ell_s^4 p^2 + 2\sqrt{2} \ell_s^3 \sum_{n \neq 0} p \cdot \alpha_n e^{-in(\sigma+\tau)} + 2\ell_s^2 \sum_{n, m \neq 0} \alpha_n \cdot \alpha_m e^{-i(n+m)(\sigma+\tau)}$$

The zero mode gives $p^2 = 0$. Noting that $\alpha_n \cdot \alpha_m = -\frac{1}{2} \alpha_n^+ \alpha_m^- - \frac{1}{2} \alpha_m^+ \alpha_n^- + \alpha_n^i \alpha_m^i = \alpha_n^i \alpha_m^i$, we look at the remaining terms of each mode individually, so:

$$\begin{aligned} 0 &= 2\ell_s p \cdot \alpha_n + \sqrt{2} \sum_m \alpha_{n-m}^i \alpha_m^i = -\ell_s p^+ \alpha_n^- + \underbrace{2\ell_s p^i \alpha_n^i}_{\alpha^i \text{ is transverse}} + \sqrt{2} \sum_m \alpha_{n-m}^i \alpha_m^i \\ \Rightarrow \alpha_n^- &= \frac{\sqrt{2}}{\ell_s p^+} \underbrace{\sum_m \alpha_{n-m}^i \alpha_m^i}_{2L_n} = \frac{\sqrt{2}}{\ell_s p^+} \left[: \sum_m \alpha_{n-m}^i \alpha_m^i : - 2a\delta_n \right] \end{aligned}$$

5. Firstly, we see that $L_0 - \bar{L}_0$ can only differ by an integer, otherwise there's no combination of $\alpha_{-n} \bar{\alpha}_{-m}$ acting on $|p^\mu\rangle$ that will give a physical state. Now let's say they differ by an integer n . Then $\alpha_{-n}^i \bar{\alpha}_{-1}^i$ will be the lowest-lying excitation at level $(n+1, 1)$. We see there are 24 of these that transform under $SO(24)$, so they must give us a massless particle. We note also that we have exactly 24 excitations at levels $(n+k, k)$ for $1 \leq k < n$, as the only way to get them is applying $\alpha_{-n-k}^i \bar{\alpha}_{-1-k}^i$. On the other hand, each of these has mass-shell condition:

$$0 = (L_0 - a) \alpha_{-n-k} \bar{\alpha}_{-k} |p^\mu\rangle \Rightarrow \ell_s^2 m^2 = 4(n+k-a)$$

However if this is massless for some value of k , it will be massive for $k+1$, breaking Lorentz invariance.

Note that $L_0 - \bar{L}_0$ generates translations along σ so this shows that any state should be invariant under $\sigma \rightarrow \sigma + c$.

6. Note that $SO(25)$ acts on 25×25 traceless symmetric tensors. Note that if we restrict to a subgroup $SO(24)$ that leaves one of the spatial directions fixed, the $SO(25)$ representation breaks down into two $SO(24)$ representations: the symmetric tensor representation (including trace) on the 24 transverse directions, and the vector representation in those directions as well. This is exactly what we have at level two. So, we see we can arrange these two $SO(24)$ rep's into the traceless symmetric $SO(25)$ tensor rep.

7. The generators (for the closed string) are:

$$J^{\mu\nu} = T \int_0^{2\pi} d\sigma (X^\mu \dot{X}^\nu - X^\nu \dot{X}^\mu) = x^\mu p^\nu - x^\nu p^\mu - i \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{n} [\alpha_{-n}^\mu \alpha_n^\nu - \alpha_{-n}^\nu \alpha_n^\mu + \overline{(\dots)}]$$

Upon computing the commutator $[J^{\mu\nu}, J^{\rho\sigma}]$ the $x^\mu p^\nu - x^\nu p^\mu$ will give no problems, and there will be no cross terms between the right and left moving modes. So it is enough to look at the left movers. **I'm gonna pass on doing this computation...**

8. For NN boundary conditions, α_k^μ is associated to the wavefunction $\cos(k\sigma)$, $\sigma \in [0, \pi]$. This has eigenvalue 1 under flip if k is even and -1 if k is odd. Thus this α_k must transform identically: $\Omega \alpha_k^\mu \Omega^{-1} = (-1)^k \alpha_k^\mu$. For DD boundary conditions, we have $\sin(k\sigma)$, which has opposite eigenvalues, so instead we get $(-1)^{k+1}$
9. This is a Lie algebra of dimension $n(n-1)/2$, which already looks promising. In the case of all θ_i equal, we can pick basis so that the R_{ij} are all 1. This is clearly $\mathfrak{so}(n)$. Now, take a diagonal unitary matrix γ (note $\gamma^T = \gamma$). Using $\lambda^T = -\gamma^{-1} \lambda \gamma$, it is clear that $\tilde{\lambda} := \gamma^{-1/2} \lambda \gamma^{1/2}$ gives the right structure under transposition:

$$\tilde{\lambda}^T = \gamma^{1/2} \lambda^T \gamma^{-1/2} = -\gamma^{1/2} \gamma^{-1} \lambda \gamma \gamma^{-1/2} = -\gamma^{-1/2} \lambda \gamma^{1/2} = -\tilde{\lambda}.$$

Since $\gamma^{1/2}$ is unitary, $\tilde{\lambda}$ is still Hermitian, so $\tilde{\lambda} = iA$ with A real antisymmetric. But since $\tilde{\lambda}$ is just a conjugation action on the λ , we will still have that the Lie algebra structure is preserved, and maintain $\mathfrak{so}(n)$. (Equivalently: the phases are absorbed by redefining the CP states $|i\rangle \rightarrow e^{i\theta_i/2} |i\rangle$, after which $\gamma = 1$.)

For the second part, again when all the $\theta_i = 0$, this is just the definition of the symplectic group and we have $\lambda = -\omega \lambda^T \omega^{-1} = \omega \lambda^T \omega$ for ω the canonical symplectic form written in the $(x_1, p_1, x_2, p_2, \dots)$ basis. Now note that the new symplectic form γ can be written as $\sigma \omega$ with $\sigma = \text{diag}(e^{i\theta_1}, e^{i\theta_1}, e^{i\theta_2}, e^{i\theta_2}, \dots)$; σ is scalar on each 2×2 block so it commutes with ω , and $\gamma^{-1} = -\omega \sigma^{-1}$. Then define $\tilde{\lambda} = \sigma^{-1/2} \lambda \sigma^{1/2}$ and note that

$$\tilde{\lambda}^T = \sigma^{1/2} \lambda^T \sigma^{-1/2} = -\sigma^{1/2} \gamma^{-1} \lambda \gamma \sigma^{-1/2} = \sigma^{1/2} \omega \sigma^{-1} \lambda \sigma \omega \sigma^{-1/2} = \omega \tilde{\lambda} \omega = -\omega \tilde{\lambda} \omega^{-1}$$

as required. Again, conjugation action will preserve the Lie algebra structure, so this will remain $\mathfrak{sp}(2n)$.

10. In the symmetric case, we have $\lambda^T = \lambda$, so these are symmetric matrices of N indices. Naturally $\text{SO}(N)$ acts on these, and we see that they can be written as $F \otimes F$ for F the fundamental representation. This can be decomposed as the trivial representation and the traceless symmetric representation.

In the anti-symmetric case with N even, I know that the symplectic group acts on $\mathbb{R}^N$. I'll call this the fundamental rep, and then note that tensoring it with its dual again gives an antisymmetric $N \times N$ matrix on which $\text{Sp}(N)$ can act. This can be decomposed into the singlet and the skew-traceless antisymmetric matrix.

11. Traceless means that any pair of indices contracted with $\eta^{\mu\nu}$ gives zero. Locally, we can pick the metric so that only $\eta_{+-} = \eta_{-+} = 1$ is nonzero. This means that $T_{i_1 \dots i_n} = 0$ if any one i is set to $+$ with the other set to $-$. Thus we can have only $T_{+ \dots +}$ and $T_{- \dots -}$ nonzero.

12. The round metric is

$$ds^2 = \frac{4dzd\bar{z}}{(1+z\bar{z})^2}$$

The Lie derivative is:

$$\mathcal{L}_X g_{ab} = X^c \partial_c g_{ab} + g_{ac} \partial_b X^c + g_{cb} \partial_a X^c \quad (5)$$

Working with $z, \bar{z}$ we get:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{L}_X g_{zz} &= 2g_{z\bar{z}} \partial_z X^{\bar{z}} = 0 \\ \mathcal{L}_X g_{\bar{z}\bar{z}} &= 2g_{z\bar{z}} \partial_{\bar{z}} X^z = 0 \\ \mathcal{L}_X g_{z\bar{z}} &= (X^z \partial_z + X^{\bar{z}} \partial_{\bar{z}}) g_{z\bar{z}} + g_{z\bar{z}} (\partial_z X^z + \partial_{\bar{z}} X^{\bar{z}}) = \lambda(z, \bar{z}) g_{z\bar{z}} \end{aligned} \quad (6)$$

The first two equations show us that $X^z, X^{\bar{z}}$ must be holomorphic and anti-holomorphic respectively. We want the function λ to be well-defined on the entire Riemann sphere and so the last equation gives us:

$$-2 \frac{(X^z \bar{z} + X^{\bar{z}} z)}{1 + z \bar{z}} + \partial_z X^z + \partial_{\bar{z}} X^{\bar{z}} = \lambda(z, \bar{z}) \quad (7)$$

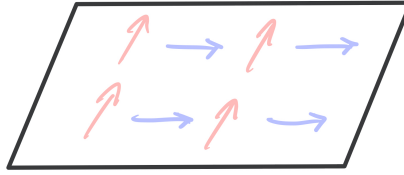
We see that $X^z, X^{\bar{z}}$ cannot have any poles. Further, they cannot grow faster than $z^2, \bar{z}^2$ respectively as $z \rightarrow \infty$ otherwise λ will blow up at the north pole. So our solutions space is spanned by $\partial_z, z\partial_z, z^2\partial_z$ and their conjugates.

Next, right away we can see that the only nonzero Christoffel symbols in the round metric are Γ_{zz}^z and $\Gamma_{\bar{z}\bar{z}}^{\bar{z}}$. Second, because T is traceless, by the previous problem we see it has only two components: T_{zz} and $T_{\bar{z}\bar{z}}$. Now looking at $\nabla^\beta T_{\alpha\beta}$ we see that this gives two equations:

$$\begin{aligned} g^{z\bar{z}} \nabla_{\bar{z}} T_{zz} &= \partial_{\bar{z}} T_{zz} \\ g^{z\bar{z}} \nabla_z T_{\bar{z}\bar{z}} &= \partial_z T_{\bar{z}\bar{z}} \end{aligned} \quad (8)$$

Note that there can be no Christoffel contribution. This simply asks for globally-defined holomorphic quadratic differentials. Let's look at T_{zz} . Around $z = 0$, it must be a polynomial to avoid poles. Transforming to $w = 1/z, dw = -dz/z^2 \Rightarrow \frac{dz}{dw} = -z^2 = -w^{-2}$ we get $T_{ww}(w) = (\frac{dz}{dw})^2 T_{zz}(w)$. Note that the right hand side will only have poles at least as bad as w^{-4} so we cannot have any global section of this vector bundle. Thus, there are no Teichmüller parameters.

13. We can think of the torus as $\mathbb{C}/\Lambda$. Note that scaling and rotation preserve the complex structure of the fundamental parallelogram so WLOG we can pick $\Lambda = \mathbb{Z}\text{-span}\{1, \tau\}$ with $\tau \in \mathbb{H}$. Thus we need vector fields on $\mathbb{C}$ that respect the translation-invariance under Λ . Any translation-invariant holomorphic function is constant, so we can only have the constant vector fields $\partial_z, \partial_{\bar{z}}$.



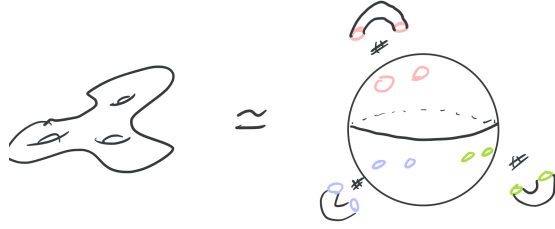
We now look for holomorphic and anti-holomorphic traceless tensors. Again, T_{zz} and $T_{\bar{z}\bar{z}}$ be translation-invariant w.r.t the lattice, so again they must be constants. We get $dz \otimes dz$ and $d\bar{z} \otimes d\bar{z}$ as our two Teichmüller deformations. As real tensors, their real and imaginary parts are:

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix} = dx \otimes dx - dy \otimes dy, \quad \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} = dx \otimes dy + dy \otimes dx,$$

14. Not sure exactly how they want us to calculate this. Let's assume they are OK with Gauss-Bonnet. For the disk with the flat metric, we have right away that the curvature R vanishes. The geodesic curvature at the boundary is a constant, and is easily seen to be 1. Integrating this over the boundary of the disk gives 2π so that $\chi = 1$.

Using the round metric, it is quick to see that the only contribution to $R_{\mu\nu} = R_{\mu z \nu}^z + R_{\mu \bar{z} \nu}^{\bar{z}}$ is for $R_{zz\bar{z}}^z = -\partial_{\bar{z}} \Gamma_{zz}^z$ and $R_{\bar{z}\bar{z}z}^{\bar{z}} = \partial_z \Gamma_{\bar{z}\bar{z}}^{\bar{z}}$ giving $R_{z\bar{z}} = \frac{2}{(1+|z|^2)^2}$. Contracting with $g^{z\bar{z}}$ gives the Gaussian curvature $K = 1$. Integrating this over half the sphere gives 2π . The geodesic curvature vanishes on the great circle by symmetry, and we get $\chi = 1$ again.

15. Any such surface can be decomposed as a sphere with $2n$ holes connected to n handles. Let's integrate the scalar curvature over each piece individually. First the curvature integrated on the sphere with $2n$ disks removed is equal to the curvature integrated on the Riemann sphere: 4π minus the curvature integrated on $2n$ disks. We have just done this in the previous problem, and we get $2\pi \times 2n$. Lastly, the curvature on the handles is just the same as the curvature on the sphere with two holes cut out, which we have just calculated is $4\pi - 2 \times 2\pi = 0$. Thus the total curvature is just $2\pi(2 - 2n)$, giving us $\chi = 2 - 2n$ as required.



16. Our point particle action is $S_0 = \frac{1}{2} \int d\tau e (e^{-2} (\partial_\tau x)^2 - m^2)$. Let's look at:

$$\int \frac{\mathcal{D}X \mathcal{D}e}{V_{gauge}} e^{-S_0} \sim \int \mathcal{D}X \mathcal{D}e \mathcal{D}b \mathcal{D}c e^{-S_0 - \int b(\delta F)c - i \int B F(e)}$$

Note we don't need an α index on B, b, c because they just parameterize the continuous symmetry with no discrete parameters:

$$(\delta_{\tau_1} \tau)(\tau) = \delta(\tau - \tau_1)$$

Using Polchinski's convention for coordinate transformation (he also has $-B_A$ of Kiritsis),

$$\delta_{\tau_1} X(\tau) = -\delta(\tau - \tau_1) \partial_\tau X, \quad \delta_{\tau_1} e(\tau) = -\partial_\tau (\delta(\tau - \tau_1) e(\tau))$$

and

$$[\delta_{\tau_1} \delta_{\tau_2}](\tau) = -(\delta(\tau - \tau_1) \partial_\tau \delta(\tau - \tau_2) - \delta(\tau - \tau_2) \partial_\tau \delta(\tau - \tau_1)) \partial_\tau \Rightarrow f_{\tau_1 \tau_2}^{\tau_3} = \delta(\tau_3 - \tau_1) \partial_{\tau_3} \delta(\tau_3 - \tau_2) - \delta(\tau_3 - \tau_2) \partial_{\tau_3} \delta(\tau_3 - \tau_1)$$

Then the BRST transformation is given by:

$$\begin{aligned} \delta_\epsilon X &= i\epsilon c \dot{X} \\ \delta_\epsilon e &= i\epsilon (\dot{c} e) \\ \delta_\epsilon b &= \epsilon B_A \\ \delta_\epsilon c &= i\epsilon c \dot{c} \\ \delta_\epsilon B &= 0 \end{aligned} \tag{9}$$

Now let's take $F(e) = e - 1$. Then we get a ghost action

$$\begin{aligned} b_A c^\alpha \delta_\alpha F^\alpha &\rightarrow \int d\tau_1 d\tau_2 b(\tau_1) c(\tau_2) \delta_{\tau_2} (1 - e(\tau_2)) \\ &= \int d\tau_1 b(\tau_1) \partial_{\tau_1} \int d\tau_2 c(\tau_2) [\delta(\tau_1 - \tau_2) e(\tau_1)] = - \int d\tau \dot{b} c \end{aligned}$$

We enforce this constraint by integrating over B . Now we will have $\delta_\epsilon e = 0$ and $\delta_\epsilon b = i\epsilon (T^X + T^{gh})$. Because we are in Euclidean signature, we have $p = \partial_t X = i\dot{X}$ and similarly $p = -ic$ ($-i$ because the real time Lagrangian has term $-i\dot{b}c$). Then the BRST current (equal to charge because we're in 1D) is:

$$Q_B = p_X \delta_B X + p_b \delta_B b = -c \dot{X}^2 - i c i (-\frac{1}{2} \dot{X} + \frac{1}{2} m^2 - \dot{b} c) = -c \frac{1}{2} \dot{X} + \frac{1}{2} m^2 = c \frac{1}{2} (p^2 + m^2) = cH.$$

Clearly $Q_B^2 = 0$. As before, the ghosts generate a two-state system. Our set of states is given by $|k^\mu, \uparrow\rangle, |k^\mu, \downarrow\rangle$. Following convention, c raises and b lowers. $Q_B |k, \downarrow\rangle = \frac{1}{2}(k^2 + m^2) |k, \uparrow\rangle$ so all states of the form $|k, \uparrow\rangle$ with $k^2 + m^2 \neq 0$ are BRST exact. Similarly all states $|k, \uparrow\rangle$ are BRST closed along with all states of the form $|k, \downarrow\rangle$ with $k^2 + m^2 = 0$. So the closed states that are not exact are $|k, \downarrow\rangle, |k, \uparrow\rangle$ with $k^2 + m^2 = 0$. We take only the states with $b|\psi\rangle = 0$. The reason is that all states $|k, \uparrow\rangle$ are physical, and so we would need amplitudes between such states to be proportional to $\delta(k^2 + m^2)$ in order for the states to decouple, but *amplitudes* cannot have such extreme singularities **Don't understand this. Appreciate it, and its relation to Siegel gauge..**

17. I believe these variations follow directly from Polchinski's formalism, up to the sign issue discussed below. Under a diffeomorphism $\delta_{\xi, \bar{\xi}} X = -\xi \partial X - \bar{\xi} \bar{\partial} X$. These are two copies of the reparameterization algebra developed in the previous problem, and so the commutation relations are the same. We get, again in Polchinski's formalism (9)

$$\begin{aligned}\delta_\epsilon X &= i\epsilon(c\partial X + \bar{c}\bar{\partial} X) \\ \delta_\epsilon c &= i\epsilon(c\partial c + \bar{c}\bar{\partial} \bar{c}) \\ \delta_\epsilon b &= i\epsilon(T^X + T^{gh})\end{aligned}\tag{10}$$

I see no problem with Q_B^2 giving zero when acting on the X and c fields.

$$\delta_B(c\partial X + \bar{c}\bar{\partial} X) = i\epsilon(c(\partial c)\partial X + \bar{c}(\bar{\partial} \bar{c})\bar{\partial} X - c\partial(\bar{c}\partial X + \bar{c}\bar{\partial} X) - \bar{c}\bar{\partial}(c\partial X + \bar{c}\bar{\partial} X))$$

and the remaining terms die by the equations of motion ($\partial \bar{c} = \bar{\partial} c = 0$, $\partial \bar{\partial} X = 0$; the $c\bar{c}\partial \bar{\partial} X$ terms also cancel by antisymmetry). The c variation will always die because we've already shown the transformations satisfy a Lie algebra with Bianchi identity.

It looks like the b field will be nontrivial. Write $\delta_B = i\epsilon s$ with s Grassmann-odd, so that $s(b\partial c) = (sb)\partial c - b\partial(sc)$. WLOG in the holomorphic sector we want to compute:

$$s(T^X + T^{gh}) = s\left(\frac{1}{\alpha}(\partial X)^2 + 2b\partial c + \partial b c\right) = \frac{2}{\alpha}\partial X\partial(c\partial X) + 2(T^X + T^{gh})\partial c - 2b\partial(c\partial c) + c\partial(T^X + T^{gh}) - \partial b c\partial c.$$

The first term is $c\partial T^X + 2\partial c T^X$, i.e. T^X transforms as a weight-2 tensor. The purely bc terms do not cancel among themselves. Rather, using $(\partial c)^2 = 0$,

$$-2bc\partial^2 c - \partial b c\partial c = c\partial T^{gh} + 2\partial c T^{gh},$$

so T^{gh} also transforms as a weight-2 tensor, and altogether

$$s(T^X + T^{gh}) = 2(c\partial + 2\partial c)(T^X + T^{gh}).$$

This does not vanish, except on the constraint surface $T^X + T^{gh} = 0$, and there is no way to get rid of it: the variations as written in Kiritsis are inconsistent with his sign for T^{gh} . If instead $T^{gh} = -(2b\partial c + \partial b c)$, the T^{gh} contribution to sb flips sign and the two weight-2 pieces cancel, $s(T^X + T^{gh}) = (1-1)(c\partial + 2\partial c)(T^X + T^{gh}) = 0$ identically. This is also the sign for which $\frac{1}{2}cT^{gh} = bc\partial c$ in Kiritsis's BRST current. Note that the coefficient of T^X in $\delta_B b$ drops out of this computation entirely. At any rate, there is no need to use $d = 26$ here.

18. Integrating over σ will as usual pick out the zero mode. For T_{++} this gives us

$$\sum_n (2nb_{-n+m}c_n + (n+m)c_{-n}b_{n+m}) = \sum_n (m-n) : b_{n+m}c_{-n} :$$

and similarly for the right-movers. To get the central charge we'll have to proceed as before, noting that only $[L_m, L_{-m}]$ can give a nonzero central term. As before, we expect only a finite part of the infinite sum to contribute to this. We thus take out the only terms of the sum with m, n having the same sign:

$$\sum_{n=1}^m (m+n)b_{m-n}c_n, \quad \sum_{n=1}^m (-2m+n)b_{-n}c_{-m+n}$$

Then our commutators of these finite terms give:

$$\begin{aligned}\sum_{k,k'} (m+k)(-2m+k')[b_{m-k}c_k, b_{-k'}c_{-m+k'}] &= \sum_{k,k'} (m+k)(-2m+k')(b_{m-k}c_{-m+k'} - b_{-k'}c_k)\delta_{k-k'} \\ &= \sum_{k=1}^m (m+k)(-2m+k)(b_{m-k}c_{-m+k} - b_{-k}c_k)\end{aligned}$$

Looking at the non-normal-ordered part, this leaves:

$$\sum_{k=1}^m b_{m-k}c_{-m+k}(m+k)(k-2m) \rightarrow \sum_{k=1}^m (m+k)(k-2m) = \frac{1}{6}(m-13m^3)$$

19. We have

$$j_B = \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial(\bar{\partial} X)} c \partial X + \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial(\bar{\partial} c)} c \partial c = \frac{2}{2\pi\alpha'} (\partial X)^2 c + \frac{1}{\pi} bc \partial c \rightarrow c T^X + bc \partial c = c T^X + \frac{1}{2} c T^{gh}$$

I don't understand how other references include a $\frac{3}{2} \partial^2 c$.

20. Let's do this for the open string, so we are then just calculating the holomorphic sector. We have:

$$Q_B = \sum_{m=-\infty}^{\infty} : (L_{-m}^X + \frac{1}{2} L_{-m}^{gh} - a \delta_{m,0}) c_m :$$

Note that the a is just from the X component of the theory since by definition Q contains the term $: c T^{gh} :$ already in normal order.

We now need to consider the total BRST charge $Q + \bar{Q}$. Then:

$$Q_B^2 = \sum_{n,m} ([L_m^X, L_n^X] + [L_m^{gh}, L_n^{gh}] - (m-n) L_{m+n}^X - (m-n) L_{m+n}^{gh} + 2am \delta_{m+n}) c_{-m} c_{-n}$$

This will vanish only if the commutators give no anomalous term. From previous exercises we see this is only if:

$$\frac{d(m^3 - m)}{12} + \frac{(m - 13m^3)}{6} + 2am = 0$$

This happens exactly when $d = 26$ and $a = 1$.

21. We now have $Q + \bar{Q}$ that we need to be zero on states. Again, each of $Q, \bar{Q}$ will no change the level, so their sum will not either, and we have a (double) grading on the space which they will preserve.

$$Q = Q_0 + Q_1, \quad Q_0 = c_0(L_0^X - 1), \quad Q_1 = c_{-1}L_1^X + c_1L_{-1}^X + c_0(b_{-1}c_1 + c_{-1}b_1)$$

and $\bar{Q}$ is the conjugate of this.

At level zero we will again have $Q^0 = c_0 L_0^X + \bar{c}_0 \bar{L}_0^X$. We now have two copies of the Clifford algebra and our Siegel gauge condition will make it so that we only consider states $|\downarrow, \downarrow, p\rangle$. Now we need $((L_0 - 1)c_0 + (\bar{L}_0 - 1)\bar{c}_0)|\downarrow, \downarrow, p\rangle = (L_0 - 1)|\uparrow, \downarrow, p\rangle + (\bar{L}_0 - 1)|\downarrow, \uparrow, p\rangle$ so we need $\frac{\ell_s^2 p^2}{4} = 1$ i.e. the total mass is $\ell_s^2 m^2 = -4$. We thus have the tachyon state.

Also because $b_0|\psi\rangle = 0$ for any physical state, we will have $\{Q, b_0\}|\psi\rangle = 0 = (L_0 - a)|\psi\rangle$ so we have $L_0 - 1 = \bar{L}_0 - 1 = 0$ and this gives us the level-matching condition. So the next level we can have a state is at $(1, 1)$.

As in the open string treatment, the most general such state has nine terms:

$$\begin{aligned} |\psi_1\rangle = & (\zeta \cdot \alpha_{-1} \bar{\zeta} \cdot \bar{\alpha}_{-1} + \zeta_{ab} \cdot \alpha_{-1} \bar{b}_{-1} + \zeta_{ac} \cdot \alpha_{-1} \bar{c}_{-1} \\ & + b_{-1} \zeta_{ba} \cdot \bar{\alpha}_{-1} + \xi_{bb} b_{-1} \bar{b}_{-1} + \xi_{bc} b_{-1} \bar{c}_{-1} \\ & + c_{-1} \zeta_{ca} \cdot \bar{\alpha}_{-1} + \xi_{cb} c_{-1} \bar{b}_{-1} + \xi_{cc} c_{-1} \bar{c}_{-1}) |\downarrow, \downarrow, p\rangle \end{aligned}$$

Let's act on this with $Q_0 + Q_1$. First lets look at Q_0 . On the $\alpha \bar{\alpha}$ term it will give eigenvalue $c_0 \frac{\alpha_0^2}{2} + \bar{c}_0 \frac{\bar{\alpha}_0^2}{2}$ while something like the $\zeta_{ab} \alpha \bar{b}$ term it will give eigenvalue $c_0 \frac{\alpha_0^2}{2} + \bar{c}_0 (\frac{\bar{\alpha}_0^2}{2} - 1)$. This will be compensated by the action of the $\bar{c}_0 (\bar{b}_{-1} \bar{c}_1)$ (from Q_1) on $\zeta_{ab} \alpha_{-1} \bar{b}_{-1}$. The exact same argument can be applied to any of those four terms - there will always be one the four bc terms of $Q_1 + \bar{Q}_1$ that will give us the extra factor of 1 from its commutation relation with that term in $|\psi_1\rangle$ (it commutes with everything else).

So we get a term $c_0 \frac{\ell_s^2 p^2}{4} |\psi_1\rangle$ which then gives the $p^2 = 0$ constraint. The remaining term comes from the $c_{-1} L_1^X + c_1 L_{-1}^X + c.c.$ action. The $c_{-1} L_1 + c_1 L_{-1}$ will each annihilate everything except six terms, giving

$$\begin{aligned} & \zeta \cdot p c_{-1} \bar{\zeta} \cdot \bar{\alpha}_{-1} + \zeta_{ab} \cdot p c_{-1} \bar{b}_{-1} + \zeta_{ac} \cdot p c_{-1} \bar{c}_{-1} \\ & + p \cdot \alpha_{-1} \zeta_{ba} \cdot \bar{\alpha}_{-1} + \xi_{bb} p \cdot \alpha_{-1} \bar{b}_{-1} + \xi_{bc} p \cdot \alpha_{-1} \bar{c}_{-1} + c.c. \end{aligned} \tag{11}$$

and the conjugate of this will contribute the conjugate terms. For this to all be zero we need each of the $\zeta_i \cdot p = 0$ as well as their conjugates. We also need $\xi_{bb} = \xi_{bc} = \xi_{cb} = 0$. We also see that $\zeta_{ba} = \zeta_{ab} = 0$.

On the other hand the general form of an exact state is also given by (11) for the ζ_i and ξ_i arbitrary. Thus all the terms involving c and/or $\bar{c}$ are exact and so upon quotienting we get $\zeta_{ac} = \zeta_{bc} = \xi_{cc} = 0$. Lastly we get the relation that we should identify $\zeta_i \bar{\zeta}_j = \zeta_i \bar{\zeta}_j + p_i \zeta'_j + \zeta'_i p_j$ ie we project out any tensor of the form $p \otimes \zeta'$ or $\zeta' \otimes p$. This is equivalent to identifying $\zeta \cong \zeta' + \xi p$ and identically for $\bar{\zeta}$.

So we have eliminated everything except for $\zeta, \bar{\zeta}$, each of which must be transverse to p and we identify ζ differing by a longitudinal p component. This is 24×24 parameters, as required.

22. If I have the Clifford algebra $C\ell(2)$, any vector v will have an orbit generated by $1, b_0, c_0, b_0 c_0$, so there can be no irreducible representation of dimension greater than 4. Further, there is a vector v_0 annihilated by b . Consider $v_1 = cv_0$ and assume it is distinct. Now $bv_1 = bc v_0 = v_0 - cb v_0 = v_0$. So v_1 and v_0 span the irreducible representation meaning that any irrep in fact has dimension 2. Thus, any higher dimensional generalization would only be (probably direct or semidirect) extensions of this and the trivial irrep, and give us no new information.